

Subnational Politics Database in Latin America - Codebook (v.0.2)

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Introduction

This document presents the coding methodology and sources for variables in the Subnational Politics Database in Latin America, covering federal countries where subnational democracy exists through the election of executive authorities in provinces and states. The database focuses on three major Latin American federal countries: Argentina, Brazil, and Mexico.

The project aims to provide comprehensive data on subnational democratic processes, electoral outcomes, and political dynamics across these three countries, enabling comparative analysis of subnational governance patterns in Latin America.

Database Overview

Objectives

- Document subnational democratic processes across Argentina, Brazil, and Mexico
- Enable comparative analysis of subnational governance patterns
- Provide researchers with standardized data on subnational elections and political dynamics
- Support studies on federalism, democratic governance, and political decentralization

Data Structure

The database employs a country-state-year structure, with observations at the subnational unit level for each electoral year. Each observation represents a subnational unit (province/state) in a given year.

Quality Assurance

All data undergo rigorous verification processes using official electoral records and cross-validation with established academic datasets where available.

Country Coverage and Temporal Scope

Table 1: Subnational Elections Coverage by Country

Country	Subnational Units	Executive Elections Start	Legislative Elections Start	Temporal Coverage	Total Observations
Argentina	24 provinces	1983	1983	1983-2024	~985
Brazil	27 federal units	1998	1998	1998-2024	~730
Mexico	32 federal entities	1985	1985	1985-2024	~1,280

Important Notes on Coverage

Argentina: Electoral data for most provinces begin in 1983 with the return to democracy. However, data for Ciudad Autónoma de Buenos Aires (formerly Capital Federal) begin in 1996 due to the enactment of the Buenos Aires City Constitution, which created the office of Head of Government (Jefe de Gobierno) elected by popular vote.

Brazil: Data for all 27 federal units begin in 1998, marking the earliest year for which systematically verified electoral data are available. Data are compiled from Tribunal Superior Eleitoral records and corroborated with ElectionsBR (Meireles et al., 2016).

Mexico: While the general starting point is 1985, several federal entities begin later due to the gradual democratization process:

- 1986: Durango, Sinaloa, Tlaxcala, Tamaulipas
- 1988: Morelos, Jalisco
- 1991: San Luis Potosí
- 1992: Zacatecas, Oaxaca
- 1993: Nayarit, Hidalgo
- 1995: Yucatán
- 1997: Mexico City (CDMX)

Variable Categories

The database is organized into the following major categories:

1. **Identification Variables** - Basic identifiers for countries, states, and time periods
2. **Executive Branch Variables** - Information about national and subnational executives
3. **Electoral Variables** - Comprehensive electoral data for executive and legislative elections
4. **Institutional Variables** - Information about electoral rules and procedures

Identification Variables

country_name

- **Description:** Name of the country
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Values:** ARGENTINA, BRAZIL, MEXICO
- **Source:** Own elaboration

country_code

- **Description:** ISO 3166-1 numeric country code
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Values:** 032 (Argentina), 076 (Brazil), 484 (Mexico)
- **Source:** ISO 3166-1 standard

state_name

- **Description:** Name of the subnational unit (province/state)
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Note:** See Appendix A for complete list of subnational units by country
- **Source:** Official administrative records

state_code

- **Description:** Numeric code for subnational unit within country
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Note:** Follows official coding systems used by each country's electoral authorities. See Appendix B for complete list of subnational codes
- **Source:** National electoral authorities

country_state_code

- **Description:** Combined country and state code (country_code + state_code)
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Format:** 5-digit numeric code
- **Note:** List of codes available in Appendix B
- **Source:** Own elaboration based on official codes

region_name

- **Description:** Geographic region within country
- **Type:** Categorical

- **Note:** Regional classifications follow established geographic divisions for each country
- **Source:** Official geographic classifications

year

- **Description:** Calendar year of observation
- **Type:** Numeric
- **Range:** 1983-2024 (varies by country)
- **Source:** Own elaboration

Executive Branch Variables

National Executive

head_name_national

- **Description:** Name of the head of state (President)
- **Type:** Text
- **Source:** World Statesmen (worldstatesmen.org) and V-Dem

sex_head_national

- **Description:** Gender of the head of state
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 0 = Male
 - 1 = Female
- **Source:** Own elaboration

term_head_national

- **Description:** Presidential term period in day/month/year format
- **Type:** Date range
- **Format:** DD/MM/YYYY - DD/MM/YYYY
- **Source:** V-Dem

years_nat_gov

- **Description:** Total duration of the president's current term in office
- **Type:** Numeric
- **Unit:** Years (decimal values allowed)
- **Measurement Logic:** Static value representing the complete length of the presidential term, repeated for each year of that term

- **Note:** For a 4-year presidential term, this variable shows "4" in each year of that presidency (years 1, 2, 3, and 4 all show "4")
- **Example:**
 - Brazil, Lula's first term (2003-2006): years_nat_gov = 4.0 for all years 2003, 2004, 2005, 2006
 - Mexico, AMLO's term (2018-2024): years_nat_gov = 6.0 for all years 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024
- **Source:** World Statesmen and V-Dem

reelec_nat_gov

- **Description:** Indicates presidential reelection
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Head of government has been reelected
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Own elaboration with V-Dem information

early_exit_nat

- **Description:** Indicates whether the president left office before completing their constitutional term
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Early departure from office (due to resignation, death, impeachment, removal, or other causes)
 - 0 = Completed full constitutional term or still in office
- **Note:** Includes all forms of premature departure regardless of cause
- **Source:** Own elaboration

head_party_national

- **Description:** Political party of the president
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Source:** World Statesmen and V-Dem

ideo_party_national

- **Description:** Ideological classification of the president's political party
- **Type:** Ordinal
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Left
 - 2 = Center-left
 - 3 = Center-right
 - 4 = Right
 - [blank] = Independent or no political affiliation

- **Note:** Classification based on party platforms and programs, not implemented policies
- **Examples:**
 - **Left (1):** Brazil's PT (Partido dos Trabalhadores) under Lula/Dilma 2003-2016
 - **Center-left (2):** Argentina's FREPASO or Brazil's PSB in coalition governments
 - **Center-right (3):** Argentina's UCR (Unión Cívica Radical) or Brazil's PSDB
 - **Right (4):** Mexico's PAN (Partido Acción Nacional) 2000-2012, Argentina's PRO under Macri
 - **Independent [blank]:** Rare at presidential level in these countries
- **Source:** Coppedge (1997), Szajkowski (2005), Murillo et al. (2010), party websites

electoral_national_year

- **Description:** Indicates whether national presidential elections were held during the year
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Presidential election year
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Electoral registries: argentina.gob.ar/dine, ine.mx, tse.jus.br

Subnational Executive

head_name_sub

- **Description:** Name of head of subnational state (Governor)
- **Type:** Text
- **Source:** For Argentina: Andy Tow's data verified with Tulia Falleti correspondence (04/21/2023). For other countries: subnational electoral information and state web portals

sex_head_sub

- **Description:** Gender of the subnational head of government
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 0 = Male
 - 1 = Female
- **Source:** Own elaboration

term_head_sub

- **Description:** Period of subnational government in day/month/year format
- **Type:** Date range
- **Format:** DD/MM/YYYY - DD/MM/YYYY
- **Source:** Electoral registries, verified with additional sources (Andy Tow for Argentina, ElectionsBR for Brazil)

change_head_sub

- **Description:** Indicates change in subnational head of government
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Year when change occurred
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Note:** Includes any change, including succession due to early departure
- **Source:** Own elaboration

cumulative_changes_head_sub

- **Description:** Running count of gubernatorial changes since start of data series
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Range:** 0 to n (where n = total changes observed)
- **Note:** Increments by 1 each time a new person assumes the governorship, including interim appointments and successions due to early departure
- **Measurement:** Cumulative count from first year of data coverage for each state
- **Example:**
 - **Buenos Aires Province, 1983-2023:**
 - 1983: Felipe Solá becomes governor (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 1)
 - 1987: Antonio Cafiero takes office (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 2)
 - 1991: Eduardo Duhalde elected (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 3)
 - 1999: Carlos Ruckauf takes office (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 4)
 - 2002: Felipe Solá returns to office (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 5)
 - 2007: Daniel Scioli elected (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 6)
 - 2015: María Eugenia Vidal takes office (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 7)
 - 2019: Axel Kicillof elected (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 8)
- **Source:** Own elaboration

years_sub_gov

- **Description:** Total duration of the governor's current term in office
- **Type:** Numeric
- **Unit:** Years (decimal values allowed)
- **Measurement Logic:** Static value representing the complete length of the gubernatorial term, repeated for each year of that term
- **Note:** For a 4-year gubernatorial term, this variable shows "4" in each year of that governorship (years 1, 2, 3, and 4 all show "4"). Value remains constant throughout the entire term.
- **Example:**
 - Buenos Aires, María Eugenia Vidal (2015-2019): years_sub_gov = 4.0 for all years 2015, 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019
 - São Paulo, João Doria (2019-2022, early departure): years_sub_gov = 3.0 for all years 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022 (reflecting actual time served)
- **Measurement Rules:**
 - Regular terms: Total constitutional term length

- Early departures: Actual time served until departure
 - Successions: Time from assumption to end of term
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral authorities

early_exit_sub

- **Description:** Indicates early departure from subnational executive office
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Early departure (resignation, death, impeachment, etc.)
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Own elaboration

reelec_sub_gov

- **Description:** Indicates whether the current governor was reelected to serve consecutive terms
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Governor was reelected (won election for consecutive term)
 - 0 = Governor was not reelected (first term, term-limited, or defeated)
 - [blank] = Not applicable (e.g., Mexico where gubernatorial reelection is prohibited)
- **Note:** Only codes direct reelection to consecutive terms, not returns to office after intervals
- **Source:** Own elaboration

years_sub_gov_contin

- **Description:** Total number of years the current governor has served across all terms in office
- **Type:** Numeric
- **Unit:** Years (decimal values allowed)
- **Measurement Logic:**
 - **Single term governors:** Same value as years_sub_gov
 - **Multi-term governors:** Cumulative years across all terms served by the same individual
 - **Interrupted service:** Includes breaks between terms if same person returns to office
- **Note:** Tracks individual tenure regardless of party changes or electoral defeats followed by comebacks
- **Example:**
 - **São Paulo, Brazil - Geraldo Alckmin:**
 - 2001-2006: First term (years_sub_gov_contin = 5.0 in 2006)
 - 2007-2010: Second consecutive term (years_sub_gov_contin = 9.0 in 2010)

- 2011-2018: Third consecutive term (years_sub_gov_contin = 17.0 in 2018)
 - **Comparison with hypothetical successor:**
 - 2019: New governor takes office (years_sub_gov_contin = 1.0 in 2019)
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral authorities

head_party_sub

- **Description:** Political party of subnational head of government
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Source:** Electoral authorities and subnational sources

ideo_party_sub

- **Description:** Ideological classification of governor's political party
- **Type:** Ordinal
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Left
 - 2 = Center-left
 - 3 = Center-right
 - 4 = Right
 - [blank] = Independent or no political affiliation
- **Note:** Classification based on party platforms and programs
- **Source:** Coppedge (1997), Szajkowski (2005), Murillo et al. (2010), party websites

Electoral Variables

Subnational Executive Elections

extraordinary_election

- **Description:** Indicates extraordinary subnational executive election
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Extraordinary election occurred
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

date_electoral_sub

- **Description:** Date of subnational executive electoral process
- **Type:** Date
- **Format:** DD/MM/YYYY
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

voters_registered_sub

- **Description:** Total registered voters for subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

total_voters_sub

- **Description:** Total people who voted in subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Includes votes for parties, blank votes, and null votes
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

voter_ratio_sub

- **Description:** Voter turnout rate for subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{total_voters_sub} / \text{voters_registered_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

valid_votes_sub

- **Description:** Total valid votes for subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

valid_votes_ratio_sub

- **Description:** Valid votes as percentage of total votes
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{valid_votes_sub} / \text{total_voters_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

invalid_votes_sub

- **Description:** Total invalid/void votes for subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

invalid_votes_ratio_sub

- **Description:** Invalid votes as percentage of total votes
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{invalid_votes_sub} / \text{total_voters_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

votes_candidate_winner

- **Description:** Total votes for winning gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

winner_candidate_ratio

- **Description:** Vote share of winning gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{votes_candidate_winner} / \text{valid_votes_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

second_place_votes

- **Description:** Total votes for second-place gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

second_place_ratio

- **Description:** Vote share of second-place gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{second_place_votes} / \text{valid_votes_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

last_place_votes

- **Description:** Total votes for last-place gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

last_place_ratio

- **Description:** Vote share of last-place gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{last_place_votes} / \text{valid_votes_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

margin_victory_exe

- **Description:** Victory margin in gubernatorial election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $\text{winner_candidate_ratio} - \text{second_place_ratio}$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

num_parties_executive_election_contest

- **Description:** Number of parties competing in gubernatorial election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

ENP

- **Description:** Effective Number of Parties competing in gubernatorial elections
- **Type:** Numeric (continuous)
- **Range:** 1.0 to n (where n = theoretical maximum based on number of candidates)
- **Formula:** $ENP = 1/\sum(p_i^2)$, where p_i is the vote share of party i
- **Calculation:** Based on Laakso and Taagepera (1979) index using vote shares of all competing parties
- **Interpretation:**
 - Values near 1.0 = dominant party system
 - Values near 2.0 = two-party competition
 - Higher values = more fragmented party system
- **Examples:**
 - **Dominant system (ENP $\approx$ 1.2):** Coahuila, Mexico, 2005 - PRI candidate wins with 89% vs. 8% PAN, 3% others
 - **Two-party competition (ENP $\approx$ 2.1):** São Paulo, Brazil, 2018 - PSDB 51.7% vs. PT 48.3% in runoff
 - **Fragmented system (ENP $\approx$ 3.8):** Buenos Aires, Argentina, 2015 - Cambiemos 35.4%, FPV 30.1%, Massa 20.8%, others 13.7%
 - **Highly fragmented (ENP $\approx$ 5.2):** CDMX, Mexico, 2018 - MORENA 32.1%, PAN 21.8%, PRD 15.4%, PRI 12.3%, others 18.4%
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

Subnational Legislative Elections

cameral_sub_leg

- **Description:** Number of chambers in subnational legislature
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Unicameral
 - 2 = Bicameral
- **Note:** Data captured for lower or single chamber only
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

date_electoral_sub_leg

- **Description:** Date of subnational legislative electoral process
- **Type:** Date
- **Format:** DD/MM/YYYY

- **Source:** Electoral authorities

voters_registered_sub_leg

- **Description:** Total registered voters for subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

total_voters_sub_leg

- **Description:** Total people who voted in subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Includes votes for parties, blank votes, and null votes
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

ratio_voters_sub_leg

- **Description:** Voter turnout rate for subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{total_voters_sub_leg} / \text{voters_registered_sub_leg}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

valid_votes_sub_leg

- **Description:** Total valid votes for subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

valid_votes_ratio_sub_leg

- **Description:** Valid votes as percentage of total votes in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{valid_votes_sub_leg} / \text{total_voters_sub_leg}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

invalid_votes_sub_leg

- **Description:** Total invalid/void votes for subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

invalid_votes_ratio_sub_leg

- **Description:** Invalid votes as percentage of total votes in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{invalid_votes_sub_leg} / \text{total_voters_sub_leg}) \times 100$

- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

votes_party_leg_winner

- **Description:** Total votes for party with most legislative seats
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

ratio_party_leg_winner

- **Description:** Vote share of party with most legislative seats
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{votes_party_leg_winner} / \text{valid_votes_sub_leg}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

votes_party_leg_second_place

- **Description:** Total votes for second-place party in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

ratio_party_leg_second_place

- **Description:** Vote share of second-place party in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{votes_party_leg_second_place} / \text{valid_votes_sub_leg}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

votes_party_leg_last_place

- **Description:** Total votes for last-place party in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

ratio_party_leg_last_place

- **Description:** Vote share of last-place party in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{votes_party_leg_last_place} / \text{valid_votes_sub_leg}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

margin_victory_leg

- **Description:** Victory margin in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $\text{ratio_party_leg_winner} - \text{ratio_party_leg_second_place}$

- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

num_parties_legislative_election_contest

- **Description:** Number of parties competing in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

num_legislative_seats

- **Description:** Total seats in lower/single chamber of subnational legislature
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

num_seats_legislative_government

- **Description:** Seats held by governor's party in subnational legislature
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Excludes coalition partners; only governor's own party
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

ratio_seats_legislative_government

- **Description:** Percentage of legislative seats held by the governor's political party
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Range:** 0.0 to 100.0
- **Formula:** $(\text{num_seats_legislative_government} / \text{num_legislative_seats}) \times 100$
- **Measurement Rules:**
 - **Party identification:** Only counts seats won by the governor's exact party
 - **Coalition exclusion:** Does not include allied or coalition parties
 - **Independent governors:** Coded as 0 when governor has no party affiliation
- **Interpretation:**
 - Values > 50.0 = Governor's party has legislative majority
 - Values < 50.0 = Governor's party in legislative minority
- **Examples:**
 - **Strong majority:** Veracruz, Mexico, 2016 - PAN Governor + 30 of 50 seats (60.0%)
 - **Bare majority:** Minas Gerais, Brazil, 2018 - NOVO Governor + 38 of 77 seats (49.4%)
 - **Weak minority:** Buenos Aires, Argentina, 2015 - Cambiemos Governor + 15 of 92 seats (16.3%)
 - **Coalition scenario:** Santa Fe, Argentina, 2019 - PJ Governor wins but allied parties hold additional seats not counted in this variable
 - **Independent governor:** Nuevo León, Mexico, 2015 - Independent Governor = 0.0% (no party affiliation)
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

num_seats_legislative_opos

- **Description:** Seats held by opposition parties in subnational legislature
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Includes all parties opposing subnational government
- **Source:** Electoral authorities

ratio_seats_legislative_opos

- **Description:** Percentage of legislative seats held by opposition
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{num_seats_legislative_opos} / \text{num_legislative_seats}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

ENPL_ELEC

- **Description:** Effective Number of Legislative Parties based on electoral vote shares
- **Type:** Numeric (continuous)
- **Range:** 1.0 to n (where n = theoretical maximum based on number of parties)
- **Formula:** $ENPL = 1 / \sum(v_i^2)$, where v_i is the vote share of party i in legislative elections
- **Calculation:** Based on Laakso and Taagepera (1979) index using vote shares of all competing parties in subnational legislative elections
- **Interpretation:**
 - Values near 1.0 = dominant party system in legislature
 - Values near 2.0 = two-party competition
 - Higher values = more fragmented party system
- **Note:** Measures party system fragmentation at the electoral level (votes) rather than seat allocation
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral authorities data

Electoral Timing Variables

electoral_sub_year

- **Description:** Indicates year with subnational executive elections
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Gubernatorial election year
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral authorities

cumulative_electoral_sub_year

- **Description:** Cumulative count of subnational executive elections
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Running total from beginning of data series

- **Source:** Own coding

concurrent_sub_nat_election

- **Description:** Indicates whether gubernatorial and presidential elections were held in the same calendar year
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Concurrent election year (both gubernatorial and presidential elections held)
 - 0 = Non-concurrent year (only one type of election or neither)
- **Measurement:** Based on calendar year, not exact election dates
- **Note:** Important for analyzing electoral coattail effects and vertical electoral coordination
- **Examples:**
 - **Concurrent (1):** Brazil, 2018 - All states elect governors in October alongside presidential election
 - **Concurrent (1):** Mexico, 2018 - 9 states (including CDMX, Jalisco, Morelos) hold gubernatorial elections same year as presidential
 - **Non-concurrent (0):** Argentina, 2017 - No presidential election, but several provinces (Buenos Aires, Córdoba, etc.) elect governors
 - **Non-concurrent (0):** Mexico, 2019 - No presidential election, but Baja California holds gubernatorial election
 - **Country patterns:** Brazil always concurrent (every 4 years), Argentina/Mexico mixed timing
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral authorities

electoral_sub_year_leg

- **Description:** Indicates year with subnational legislative elections
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Legislative election year
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral authorities

cumulative_electoral_sub_year_leg

- **Description:** Cumulative count of subnational legislative elections
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Running total from beginning of data series
- **Source:** Own coding

concurrent_sub_nat_election_leg

- **Description:** Indicates concurrent subnational legislative and national elections
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**

- 1 = Concurrent legislative and national election year
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral authorities

Political Alignment

alignment

- **Description:** Indicates political alignment between national president and subnational governor
 - **Type:** Binary
 - **Values:**
 - 1 = Political alignment exists
 - 0 = No political alignment
 - **Coding Criteria:** Following Giraudy (2015) and Niedzwiecki (2018), coded as 1 if any of the following conditions are met:
 - **Same party membership:** President and governor belong to the same political party
 - **Coalition partnership:** Governor's party is part of the president's legislative coalition at national level
 - **Political cooperation:** Despite different party affiliations, observable political affinity and cooperative behavior exists between president and governor
 - **Examples:**
 - **Criterion 1 - São Paulo, 2003:** PT President Lula + PT Governor José Genoíno = 1 (same party)
 - **Criterion 2 - Santa Fe, Argentina, 2008:** PJ President Cristina Kirchner + PS Governor Hermes Binner = 1 (PS supports national government coalition)
 - **Criterion 3 - Nuevo León, Mexico, 2001:** PAN President Fox + Independent Governor Natividad González = 1 (cooperation despite different affiliations)
 - **No alignment - Córdoba, Argentina, 2017:** Cambiemos President Macri + PJ Governor Schiavetti = 0 (opposition parties, no cooperation)
 - **Note:** Focuses on political cooperation rather than strict party membership
 - **Source:** Own identification based on established methodology
-

Data Sources and Methodology

Primary Sources

Argentina:

- Dirección Nacional Electoral (argentina.gob.ar/dine)
- Andy Tow's Electoral Repository (andytow.com)
- Cross-verification with academic sources

Brazil:

- Tribunal Superior Eleitoral (tse.jus.br)
- ElectionsBR database (Meireles et al., 2016)
- State electoral tribunals

Mexico:

- Instituto Nacional Electoral (ine.mx)
- State Electoral Institutes (Instituto Electoral Estatal)
- Local electoral authorities

Verification Procedures

1. **Primary Source Verification:** All data cross-checked with official electoral records
2. **Academic Validation:** Comparison with established academic datasets where available
3. **Multiple Source Confirmation:** Key variables verified through multiple independent sources
4. **Temporal Consistency Checks:** Longitudinal data reviewed for consistency and logical progression

Coding Methodology

Ideological Classification: Based on party platforms and stated positions rather than implemented policies, following established academic classifications (Coppedge 1997, Murillo et al. 2010).

Electoral Calculations: All derived variables (percentages, ratios, indices) calculated using standardized formulas for cross-country comparability.

Missing Data Treatment: Missing values coded explicitly; systematic patterns documented and explained.

Appendices

Appendix A: Subnational Units by Country

Argentina (24 units)

Buenos Aires, Ciudad Autónoma de Buenos Aires, Catamarca, Chaco, Chubut, Córdoba, Corrientes, Entre Ríos, Formosa, Jujuy, La Pampa, La Rioja, Mendoza, Misiones, Neuquén, Río Negro, Salta, San Juan, San Luis, Santa Cruz, Santa Fe, Santiago del Estero, Tierra del Fuego, Tucumán

Brazil (27 units)

Acre, Alagoas, Amapá, Amazonas, Bahia, Ceará, Distrito Federal, Espírito Santo, Goiás, Maranhão, Mato Grosso do Sul, Mato Grosso, Minas Gerais, Pará, Paraíba, Paraná, Pernambuco, Piauí, Rio de Janeiro, Rio Grande do Norte, Rio Grande do Sul, Rondônia, Roraima, Santa Catarina, São Paulo, Sergipe, Tocantins

Mexico (32 units)

Aguascalientes, Baja California, Baja California Sur, Campeche, Ciudad de México, Chiapas, Chihuahua, Coahuila, Colima, Durango, Guanajuato, Guerrero, Hidalgo, Jalisco, México, Michoacán, Morelos, Nayarit, Nuevo León, Oaxaca, Puebla, Querétaro, Quintana Roo, San Luis Potosí, Sinaloa, Sonora, Tabasco, Tamaulipas, Tlaxcala, Veracruz, Yucatán, Zacatecas

Appendix B: State Codes by Country

Table B.1: Complete List of Subnational Units with Codes

Country	Country Code	State Name	State Code Combined Code	
ARGENTINA	032			
Argentina	032	BUENOS AIRES	06	03206
Argentina	032	CAPITAL FEDERAL	02	03202
Argentina	032	CATAMARCA	10	03210
Argentina	032	CHACO	22	03222
Argentina	032	CHUBUT	26	03226
Argentina	032	CORDOBA	14	03214
Argentina	032	CORRIENTES	18	03218
Argentina	032	ENTRE RIOS	30	03230
Argentina	032	FORMOSA	34	03234
Argentina	032	JUJUY	38	03238
Argentina	032	LA PAMPA	42	03242
Argentina	032	LA RIOJA	46	03246
Argentina	032	MENDOZA	50	03250

Country	Country Code	State Name	State Code	Combined Code
Argentina	032	MISIONES	54	03254
Argentina	032	NEUQUEN	58	03258
Argentina	032	RIO NEGRO	62	03262
Argentina	032	SALTA	66	03266
Argentina	032	SAN JUAN	70	03270
Argentina	032	SAN LUIS	74	03274
Argentina	032	SANTA CRUZ	78	03278
Argentina	032	SANTA FE	82	03282
Argentina	032	SANTIAGO DEL ESTERO	86	03286
Argentina	032	TIERRA DEL FUEGO	94	03294
Argentina	032	TUCUMAN	90	03290
BRAZIL	076			
Brazil	076	ACRE	12	07612
Brazil	076	ALAGOAS	27	07627
Brazil	076	AMAPA	16	07616
Brazil	076	AMAZONAS	13	07613
Brazil	076	BAHIA	29	07629
Brazil	076	CEARA	23	07623
Brazil	076	DISTRITO FEDERAL	53	07653
Brazil	076	ESPIRITO SANTO	32	07632
Brazil	076	GOIAS	52	07652
Brazil	076	MARANHAO	21	07621
Brazil	076	MATO GROSSO DO SUL	50	07650
Brazil	076	MATO GROSSO	51	07651
Brazil	076	MINAS GERAIS	31	07631

Country	Country Code	State Name	State Code	Combined Code
Brazil	076	PARA	15	07615
Brazil	076	PARAIBA	25	07625
Brazil	076	PARANA	41	07641
Brazil	076	PERNAMBUCO	26	07626
Brazil	076	PIAUI	22	07622
Brazil	076	RIO DE JANEIRO	33	07633
Brazil	076	RIO GRANDE DO NORTE	24	07624
Brazil	076	RIO GRANDE DO SUL	43	07643
Brazil	076	RONDÔNIA	11	07611
Brazil	076	RORAIMA	14	07614
Brazil	076	SANTA CATARINA	42	07642
Brazil	076	SAO PAULO	35	07635
Brazil	076	SERGIPE	28	07628
Brazil	076	TOCANTINS	17	07617
MEXICO	484			
Mexico	484	AGUASCALIENTES	01	48401
Mexico	484	BAJA CALIFORNIA	02	48402
Mexico	484	BAJA CALIFORNIA SUR	03	48403
Mexico	484	CAMPECHE	04	48404
Mexico	484	CDMX	09	48409
Mexico	484	CHIAPAS	07	48407
Mexico	484	CHIHUAHUA	08	48408
Mexico	484	COAHUILA	05	48405
Mexico	484	COLIMA	06	48406
Mexico	484	DURANGO	10	48410

Country	Country Code	State Name	State Code	Combined Code
Mexico	484	GUANAJUATO	11	48411
Mexico	484	GUERRERO	12	48412
Mexico	484	HIDALGO	13	48413
Mexico	484	JALISCO	14	48414
Mexico	484	MEXICO	15	48415
Mexico	484	MICHOACAN	16	48416
Mexico	484	MORELOS	17	48417
Mexico	484	NAYARIT	18	48418
Mexico	484	NUEVO LEON	19	48419
Mexico	484	OAXACA	20	48420
Mexico	484	PUEBLA	21	48421
Mexico	484	QUERETARO	22	48422
Mexico	484	QUINTANA ROO	23	48423
Mexico	484	SAN LUIS POTOSI	24	48424
Mexico	484	SINALOA	25	48425
Mexico	484	SONORA	26	48426
Mexico	484	TABASCO	27	48427
Mexico	484	TAMAULIPAS	28	48428
Mexico	484	TLAXCALA	29	48429
Mexico	484	VERACRUZ	30	48430
Mexico	484	YUCATAN	31	48431
Mexico	484	ZACATECAS	32	48432

Appendix C: Key References

Coppedge, Michael. 1997. "A classification of Latin American political parties." *Working Paper #224*. Kellogg Institute.

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